

Theseus — Quick Start

Guide 1 of 6

TL;DR

Theseus is a small group of web surfaces that together turn the documents and conversations you upload into a coherent, citation-grounded view of what your firm believes. This guide is a thirty-minute first session: you will sign in, upload one document, watch claims extract, ask the Oracle a question, and observe a Currents opinion form. By the end you will know which screen does which thing, and which of the five other guides to read next.

You will need

- A signed-in browser session on the Codex (`theseus-codex` deployment).
- One document you are willing to upload as a starter corpus item — a memo, transcript, essay, or PDF. Public material is easiest for a first walkthrough.
- Roughly thirty uninterrupted minutes.

This guide does NOT cover

- How extraction and clustering work internally — see Guide 2.
- Citation quality and hallucination warnings in depth — Guide 3.
- How Currents opinions are generated and the eight invariants that govern them — Guide 4.
- Prediction markets and equities, paper vs. live, the eight safety gates — Guide 5.
- Founder-only operator controls (kill switch, deletion, live authorization) — Guide 6.

1 What Theseus is

Theseus is not one product; it is a small constellation of related surfaces that share a database. Three of them matter for the first session:

- **Codex** (authed, founder-facing). The control plane. You upload documents, inspect extracted claims, ask the Oracle, and manage published material here.
- **Public site** (reader-facing). What outside readers see: articles, conclusions, principles, Currents opinions, the forecasts grid.
- **Currents** (public, separate origin). Live commentary on outside events the firm's corpus has something to say about.

The Codex is what you spend most of your time in. The public site is what your work eventually surfaces on. Currents is a constant background process you read like a feed.

2 The first thirty minutes

2.1 Step 1 — sign in and orient

Open the Codex deployment. You land on the dashboard. The left rail shows the top-level surfaces; for now you only need four: **Upload**, **Knowledge**, **Ask**, **Currents**.

[screenshot screenshots/01_quick_start_dashboard.png not yet captured — The authenticated dashboard, with the four surfaces this guide uses highlighted.]

2.2 Step 2 — upload one document

Click **Upload**. Drag a file in. PDFs, markdown, text files, and transcripts are all accepted. After the upload completes the file appears in the upload list with a small `processing` badge. This badge clears once extraction finishes, which usually takes a few seconds for short text and a minute or two for a long PDF.

You do not need to do anything else here. The pipeline takes the file from this point. See Guide 2 for what it does to the file along the way.

2.3 Step 3 — watch claims extract

Open **Knowledge**. You will see the upload you just made, with a small `claims` count growing as extraction runs. Click into your upload to see the extracted claims — short, declarative statements with provenance back to the source text.

If your upload is the first piece of content in the corpus, this list is also the first row of your firm's working memory.

2.4 Step 4 — ask the Oracle

Open **Ask**. Type a question that the document you just uploaded would plausibly inform. The Oracle answers with inline citations back to claims and uploaded content. Click any citation to jump to the source.

For first-session expectations: do not expect the Oracle to be all-knowing. It only knows what is in the corpus. With one document uploaded, its answers will be narrow. That is correct behavior.

[screenshot screenshots/01_quick_start_ask.png not yet captured — An Oracle answer, with inline citations linking back to the uploaded source.]

If the Oracle returns a hallucination warning or a low-confidence banner, do not be alarmed. Read Guide 3 for what those mean and what to do.

2.5 Step 5 — observe a Currents opinion

Open **Currents**. If the Currents pipeline has been live for any period, you will see public opinions written by Theseus on outside events. Each opinion has a small audit trail of citations back to firm material. If the corpus is too sparse to support commentary on a particular event, you will see an explicit abstention rather than fabricated commentary.

Currents is the place to develop a feel for the firm's voice in the wild. Guide 4 explains where opinions come from, what controls them, and how to read their audit trails.

3 What you just saw

Five surfaces, one pipeline. Documents enter through **Upload**, get broken into claims that live in **Knowledge**, get clustered into principles that surface on the public site, get cited by the **Oracle** when

you ask questions, and get cited by Currents when the firm has something to say about outside news. Everything else in the Codex is a refinement of one of these five surfaces.

4 Common first-session frictions

- **The Oracle returned “I don’t have enough sources.”** That is the correct response when the corpus is sparse. Upload more material in the same topic area, or rephrase the question to something your single uploaded document actually addresses.
- **No Currents opinions are appearing.** Currents requires an X ingestion token and at least three relevant Conclusions in the corpus. See `docs/operator/CURRENTS.md` for the operator-side health check, and Guide 4 for the pipeline.
- **Upload sits in processing for a long time.** Large PDFs take time. If processing exceeds five minutes for a single document, check the founder dashboard’s **OperatorPulse** card — it shows which scheduler loops are live.

5 Where the docs are

- `docs/operator/CURRENTS.md` — operator notes for the Currents pipeline.
- `docs/operator/public_surfacing.md` — the authoritative table of which public surfaces are backed by which database rows.
- `docs/operations/Forecasts_Founder_Alpha_Runbook.md` — the single page a founder needs when moving the forecasts portfolio from read-only to live.

Where to read next

Continue with [Guide 2 — Knowledge and Principles](#) for how the firm turns uploaded material into reusable principles. That guide picks up the moment your upload finishes processing.